Structure of Business Letter

Structure of Business Letter

- Heading/Sender's Address
- Date
- Inside Address
- Salutation
- Body
- Closing
- Signature line

Standard Elements

Letterhead/Sender's address

Date

Inside address

Subject Line

Salutation

The body

Complimentary close

Signature block

Additional Elements

Attention line

Reference initials

Reference line

Enclosure notation

Copy notation

Mailing notation

Postscript

Elements of a Business Letter

1. Heading
2. Date
3. Inside Address
4. Reference
5. Subject
6. Attention Line
7. Salutation
8. Body
9. Complimentary Close
10. Signature
11. Identification Marks
12. Enclosure
13. Copy Notation



Elements of a Business Letter

- **Heading**
- Also known as **the letterhead**
- Shows the **sender/organization's** name, full address, telephone/fax numbers & e-mail id.

Hi Tech Graphics

613, Circular Road, Bangalore-560001

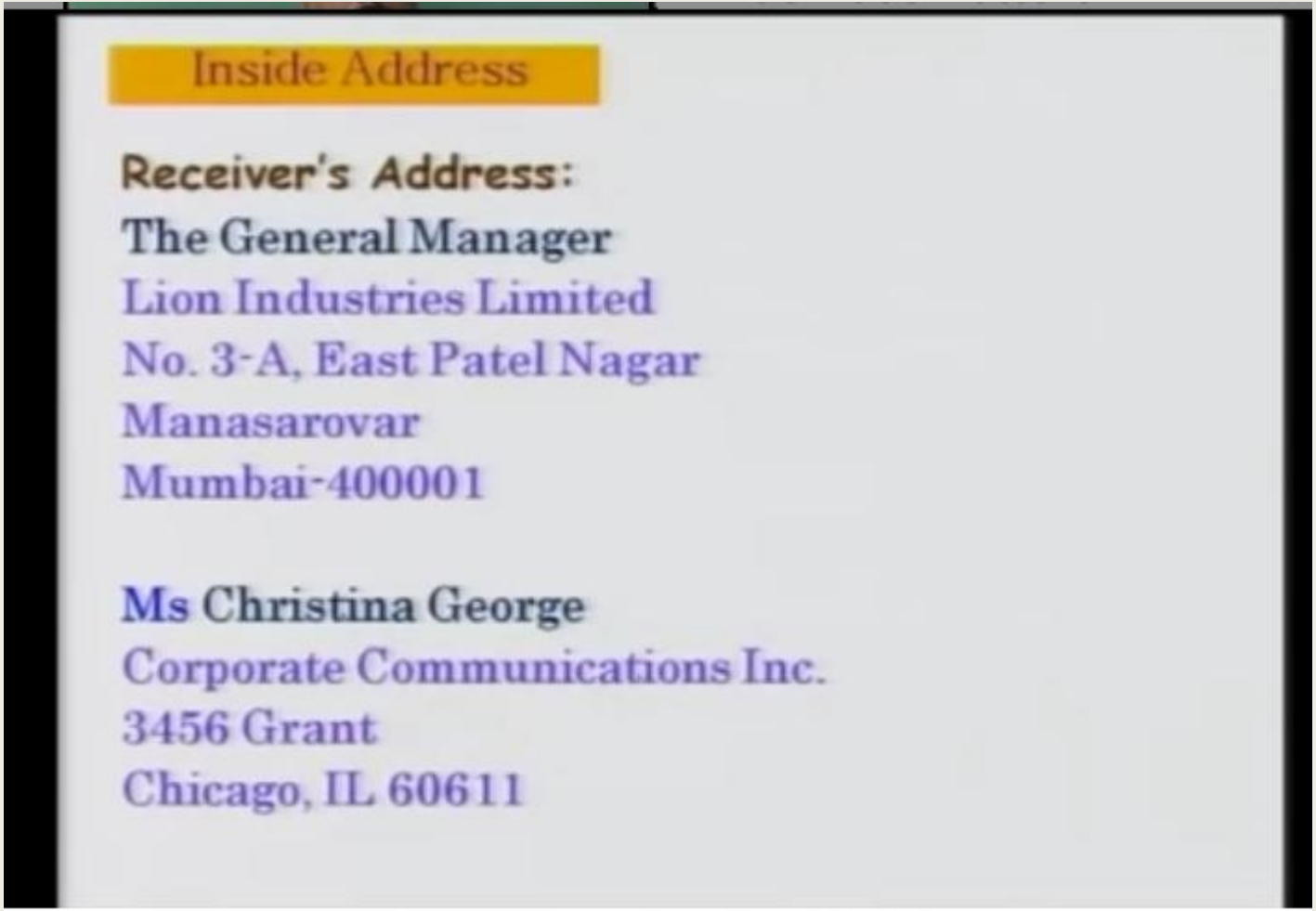
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Heading

NO Punctuation

Hi Tech Graphics
613 Circular Road
Bangalore 560001
Phone (080) 2335618
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E-mail sales@hitechgraphics.com


Inside Address
Receiver's Address:
The General Manager
Lion Industries Limited
No. 3-A, East Patel Nagar
Manasarovar
Mumbai-400001
Ms Christina George
Corporate Communications Inc.
3456 Grant
Chicago, IL 60611

Inside Address

Titles:

Mr, Sri., Mrs (misiz), Smt., Miss (mis), Kum., Ms (miz), Dr, Capt., Prof.,

Firm: Messers (Ram and Company)

Messers (Lal Chand and Sons)

Note: Bharat Aluminum Limited

Professor (Mrs) Shiela Singh

Professor (Ms) Gayatri Devi

Attention Line & Salutation

Attention Line:

Attention: The Sales Manager
Attention: Mr. S. K. Gupta
Attention: Mr. Ramesh Kumar,
Incharge, Water Supply

Salutation: Greeting

Honorable Sir, Respected Sir, Dear Sir/s,
Dear Madam, Dear Subscriber, My Dear Sir,
Dear Mr. Aswin Kumar, Dear Mr. Kumar,
Dear Mr. Aswin, Dear Aswin, My dear Aswin,
Dearest Aswin, My dearest Aswin, Aswin,

Formal (use of colon) Dear Mr Gupta:

Salutations/ Greetings to avoid

Not all the greetings mentioned in the previous slide should be used

- *My Dear Ashwin*
- *My dearest Ashwin*
- *Dearest*

Body of the Letter

Body/Message: 3 main divisions

First Paragraph: Introduction and statement of the purpose

Middle Paragraph/s: Details and other information surrounding the purpose

Final Paragraph: Polite closing, expression or appreciation for assistance (even if in advance), and/or statement of follow-up intentions, expected actions

Complimentary Close

A courteous leave-taking—a polite way of ending a letter.

Typed two spaced below the last line of the body of the letter.

The close must agree with the salutation:

The salutation	*The complimentary close*
Sir,	Yours faithfully/respectfully/obediently,
Dear Sir/Madam,	Yours faithfully/truly,
Dear Mr. Nigam	Yours sincerely,
Dear Reader,	Yours sincerely,

Neutral & widely accepted closing:

Sincerely,

Cordially,

Signature

Signed name of the writer

It gives authenticity to the information contained in the letter.

Includes often the name, the title (especially if the name is likely to leave the reader in doubt) and the position (if already not mentioned in the letter head)

Cordially,

Sheetal Singh

(Ms. Sheetal Singh)

Senior Executive

Delegated authority by the Power of Attorney

Sincerely,

Per Pro. Sharewell Industries [*per pro: on behalf of*]

Lakshmi Despande

(Mrs. Lakshmi Despande)

Enclosure

Any documents attached to the letter

Encl.: 1

Enclosures: Two

If the document attached are important they are specified:

Encls: 1. MOU dated 1 September, 2010.

2. SBI Cheque No. K4876, 4 September 2010.

Copy Notation

Indicates the person who is receiving a courtesy/carbon copy (*CC*) or photocopy (*PC*):

CC: S. K. Khanna
PC: Julie Andrews

Copy to: Mr. Sanjay Bhatia
C: Rahul Bhatia

SAMPLE OF A BUSINESS LETTER

New Delhi
10 Sept. 2024

The Manager
JSW Steel Ltd.
Lower Parel
Mumbai

Subject- Inquiry for job vacancy

Dear Sir:

I wish to enquire whether you have a vacancy for a Mechanical Engineer in your company. I have a B.Tech. from Delhi Technological University. At present, I am working for a steel foundry but the work is repetitive and hardly challenging.

I hear that your company is involved in leading edge industrial design. This is something I am really interest in and I would really appreciate it if I am given a chance to participate in it. Industrial design is a fast changing field and I feel that I would be left behind if I do not get involved in it soon.

I look forward to hearing from you.

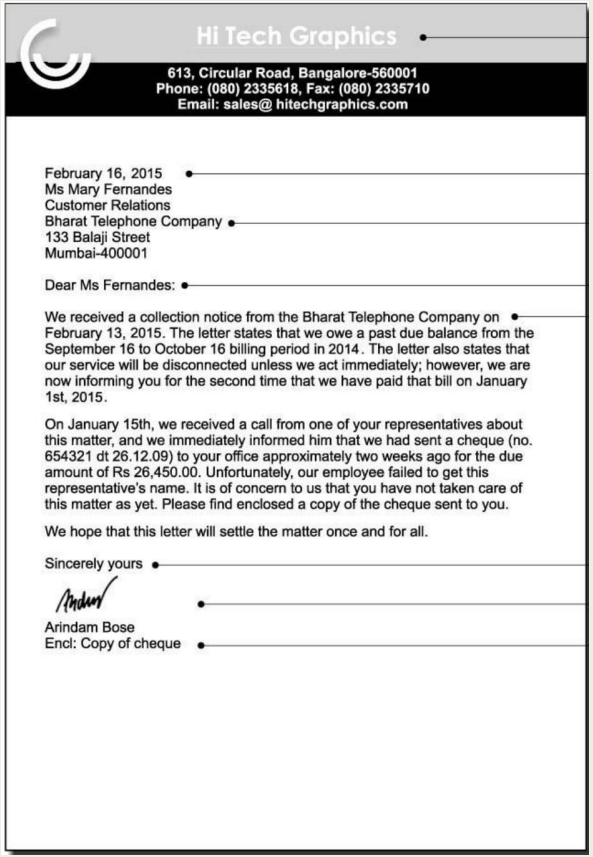
Sincerely,

(Amit Kumar)
Email-amkumar@gmail.com, mobile no.-

Enclosure- copy of my resume and other relevant documents

LAYOUT OF BUSINESS LETTER

Block layout



Hi Tech Graphics

613, Circular Road, Bangalore-560001
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Email: sales@ hitechgraphics.com

February 16, 2015
Ms Mary Fernandes
Customer Relations
Bharat Telephone Company
133 Balaji Street
Mumbai-400001

Dear Ms Fernandes:

We received a collection notice from the Bharat Telephone Company on February 13, 2015. The letter states that we owe a past due balance from the September 16 to October 16 billing period in 2014. The letter also states that our service will be disconnected unless we act immediately; however, we are now informing you for the second time that we have paid that bill on January 1st, 2015.

On January 15th, we received a call from one of your representatives about this matter, and we immediately informed him that we had sent a cheque (no. 654321 dt 26.12.09) to your office approximately two weeks ago for the due amount of Rs 26,450.00. Unfortunately, our employee failed to get this representative's name. It is of concern to us that you have not taken care of this matter as yet. Please find enclosed a copy of the cheque sent to you.

We hope that this letter will settle the matter once and for all.

Sincerely yours

Arindam Bose
Encl: Copy of cheque

- The block layout, also known as the complete block layout is extremely popular as it makes the letter look attractive, elegant, and efficient.
- The main characteristic of this layout is that all elements except the letterhead heading are aligned to the left margin.

Layout: Left Aligned

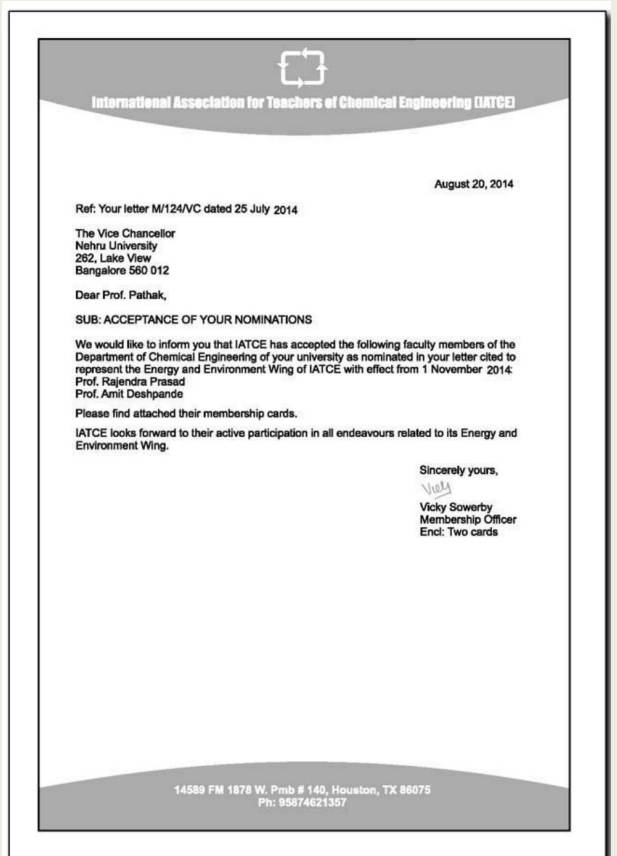
Heading
Date
Inside Address
Reference
Subject
Attention Line
Salutation
Body
Complimentary Close
Signature
Identification Marks
Enclosure

Modified Block layout

- The modified block format differs from the block format in the positioning of certain elements:
- the heading is centre aligned whereas the dateline, complimentary close, and signature block are right-aligned.

- Although organizations seem to prefer the full block format, the modified block is also acceptable.

- The modified block's appearance is often considered to be more balanced and traditional.



International Association for Teachers of Chemical Engineering (IATCE)

August 20, 2014

Ref: Your letter M/124/VC dated 25 July 2014

The Vice Chancellor
Nehru University
262, Lake View
Bangalore 560 012

Dear Prof. Pathak,

SUB: ACCEPTANCE OF YOUR NOMINATIONS

We would like to inform you that IATCE has accepted the following faculty members of the Department of Chemical Engineering of your university as nominated in your letter cited to represent the Energy and Environment Wing of IATCE with effect from 1 November 2014:
Prof. Rajendra Prasad
Prof. Amit Deshpande

Please find attached their membership cards.

IATCE looks forward to their active participation in all endeavours related to its Energy and Environment Wing.

Sincerely yours,

Vicky Sowerby
Membership Officer
Encl: Two cards

14589 FM 1878 W. Pmb # 140, Houston, TX 86075
Ph: 95874621357

Layout: Standard

Heading

Date

Inside Address

Reference

Subject

Attention Line

Salutation

Body

Complimentary Close

Signature

Identification Marks

Enclosure

Copy Notation